

Skin

The largest organ in the body, the skin forms a barrier between the body's insides and the outside world. Waterproof, germ-proof, and self-repairing, the skin also screens out harmful rays from the Sun and allows people to feel their surroundings.

Skin-deep

The skin has two layers. The upper, protective epidermis consists mainly of flattened cells packed with keratin, a tough, waterproof protein. Below that, the thicker dermis contains blood vessels, nerves, sweat glands, and other structures.

Sebaceous glands

release sebum, an oily substance that softens the skin

Hair follicles

are narrow pouches from which hair grows

Arteries

supply food and oxygen to skin cells

Nerves

carry signals from the sensors to the brain

Sweat glands

release sweat

